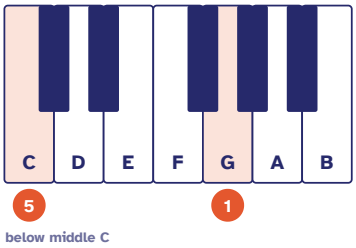
SONG 5

Ode to Joy

Beethoven's most famous tune, and now it is yours. Play it after dinner.

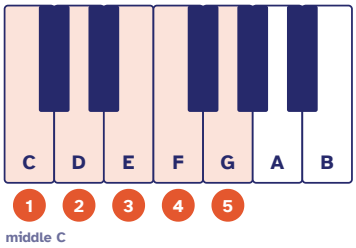
Hear it first

LEFT HAND



C with finger 5, G with the thumb.

RIGHT HAND



Thumb on middle C, one finger for each key.

THE SONG

A big tune made of small steps. Look for the line that comes back.

	3	3	4	5	5	4	3	2	1	1	2	3	3	2	2	
R.H.	E	E	F	G	G	F	E	D	C	C	D	E	E	D	D	—
	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
	Joy-	ful,	joy-	ful,	we	a-	dore	thee,	God	of	glo-	ry,	Lord	of	love;	
L.H.	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—

	3	3	4	5	5	4	3	2	1	1	2	3	2	1	1	
R.H.	E	E	F	G	G	F	E	D	C	C	D	E	D	C	C	—
	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
	hearts	un-	fold	like	flowers	be-	fore	thee,	o-	pening	to	the	sun	a-	bove	
L.H.	C	—	—	—	G	—	—	—	C	—	—	—	C	—	—	—

☐ Left hand alone ☐ Right hand alone ☐ Both hands ☐ For someone

SONG 5 · THE LEFT HAND, AGAIN

Ode to Joy, Four Ways

Ode to Joy again. Rests in new places: the left hand starts to talk back to the tune.

Big beats only. Count out loud; the dot is a lift. On G bars, the same rhythm on G.

Way 1
hold, lift, go

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	—	○	C	D	—	○	D

Way 2
play, lift, two

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
C	○	C	C	D	○	D	D

Way 3
late start

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
○	○	C	—	○	○	D	—

Way 4
the answer

1	2	3	4	1	2	3	4
○	C	—	C	○	D	—	D

SAY IT, TAP IT, PLAY IT

Say the name of the way out loud in time. Tap it on your knee with the left hand. Then play it with the song.

☐ Way 1 ☐ Way 2 ☐ Way 3 ☐ Way 4